

Wei Lin

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Education

University of Padova

M.Sc. in Applied Economics Final grade: 110/110

Padova, Italy

Sep. 2024 – Jul. 2026

- Thesis grade 7/7 (advisor: Prof. Antonio Nicolò).
- Padua International Excellence Scholarship; IELTS 7.0; GMAT 690.

Zhejiang University

B.A. in Economics GPA: 3.39/4.00

Hangzhou, China

Sep. 2018 – Jun. 2023

Research Interests

Market design and centralized school choice; economics of education; gender differences in educational choices; family decision-making; separating preferences from beliefs in choice data.

Research Experience

Master's Thesis (Independent Research)

University of Padova

Gendered Preferences in Centralized School Choice: Evidence from Chile's School Admission System

2025 – 2026

- Built the estimation dataset from raw administrative admission records across five entry stages ($\approx 448,000$ applicants, $\approx 1.5M$ ranked rows), then specified and estimated rank-ordered (exploded) conditional logit models on families' submitted ranked lists with choice-set-centered covariates; all data construction and estimation in Python.
- Main finding: applications submitted for girls place greater relative weight on school social composition than those submitted for boys; strongest in Secondary (0.0334; odds ratio ≈ 1.03), robust across ten specifications and every cohort 2017–2025, and specific to social composition rather than quality, distance, or demand.
- Addressed the identification problem of recovering preferences from rankings submitted to a strategy-proof mechanism: the model assumes only weak truth-telling, so the estimates are a conservative lower bound. Ruled out scale, safety, and popularity as alternative explanations; decompositions attribute about one-fifth of the gender difference in admitted-school social composition to the within-list ranking channel.
- Whether the difference reflects preferences or beliefs is not identified from submitted rankings alone; separating them would require elicited expectations, which is what I want to work on next.

Zhejiang University, Economics Department

Hangzhou, China

Research Assistant, Behavioral and Experimental Economics

Mar. 2021 – Dec. 2021

- Designed and ran laboratory experiments (zTree, 12 sessions, 210 participants) on social influence, information sharing, and risk-taking, with incentivized elicitation under three information conditions (public, partial, private); analyzed gender heterogeneity in risk preferences and susceptibility to peer influence; cleaned $>8,000$ decision-level records in Stata and Python.

Zhejiang University, China Institute of Urbanization

Hangzhou, China

Research Assistant, Applied Causal Inference on Firm-Level Data

Mar. 2023 – Jun. 2023

- Estimated a difference-in-differences model of a spatial policy shock on firm output and employment, using linked administrative, firm-level, and geospatial data ($\approx 9.4\%$ output losses in high-exposure zones).

Data Analysis and Field Experience

Market Development Analyst, Wenzhou Municipal Bureau of Commerce, Wenzhou, China

Sep. 2023 – Jun. 2024

- Compiled and analyzed $>25,000$ order-level records from social-network selling channels (WeChat groups, Douyin/TikTok livestreams) covering 53 villages in 6 townships over 7 months, alongside primary field data on rural distribution.
- Designed a referral scheme built on local social ties (village opinion leaders) to overcome low trust in unfamiliar sellers; built a seasonal demand-forecasting model from historical sales records.

Summer Intern, Retail Banking, Zhejiang Commercial Bank Co., Ltd., Hangzhou, China

Mar. 2020 – Jul. 2020

- Cleaned, linked, and constructed features from individual-level customer records across several internal systems (transactions, product holdings, campaign logs) in SQL and Python.
- Estimated logit models of product take-up and duration (survival) models of attrition; evaluated interventions with A/B tests, difference-in-differences, and propensity-score matching.

Skills

Python, Stata, MATLAB, SQL, ArcGIS, LaTeX.